National GRIP
Graduate Research Innovation Programme

From Lab to Launch: Building your Deep Tech Venture



NRF SINGAPORE
NUS National University of Singapore
NANYANG TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY SINGAPORE

Dr. ANDALAM Sidharta
2026

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Value Proposition Statement



National GRIP
Graduate Research Innovation Programme

Value Hierarchy



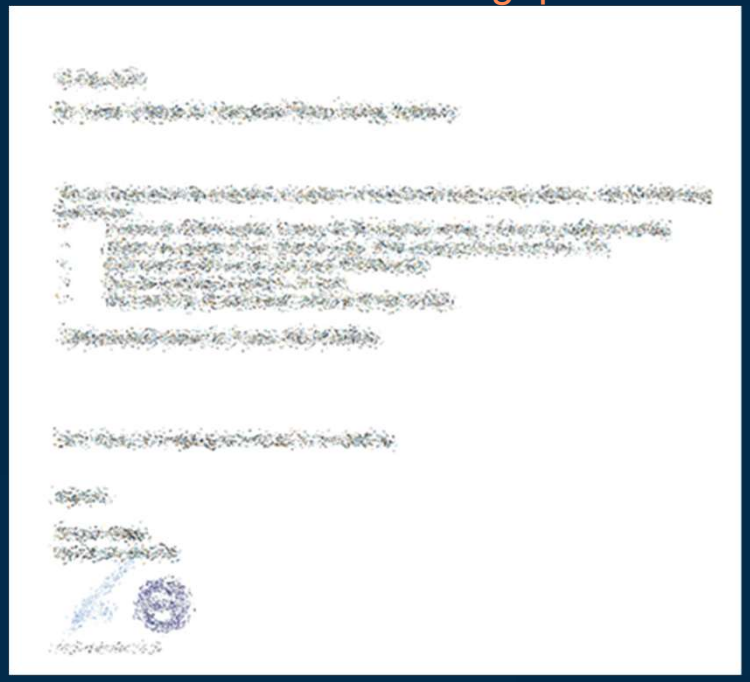
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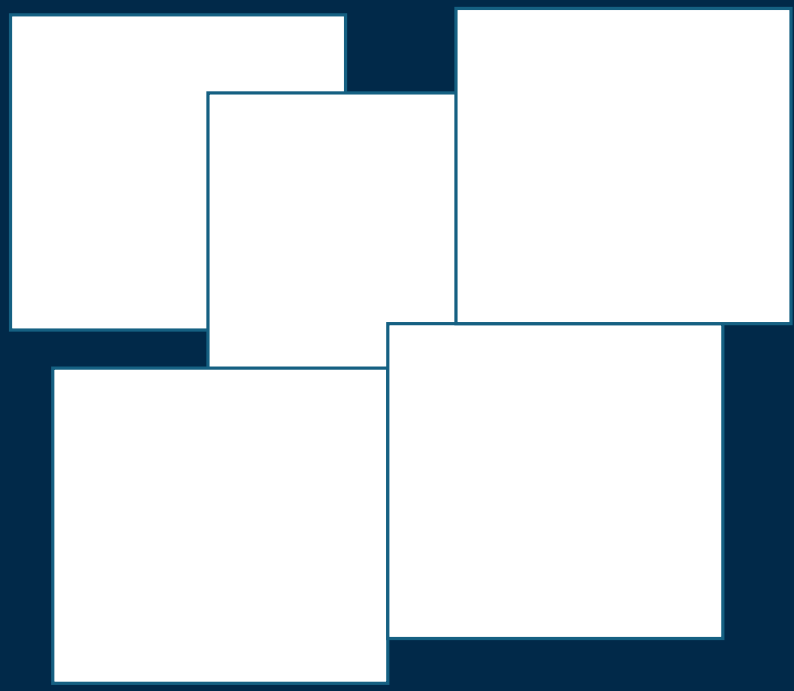
S$2.X Million

from one customer in Singapore



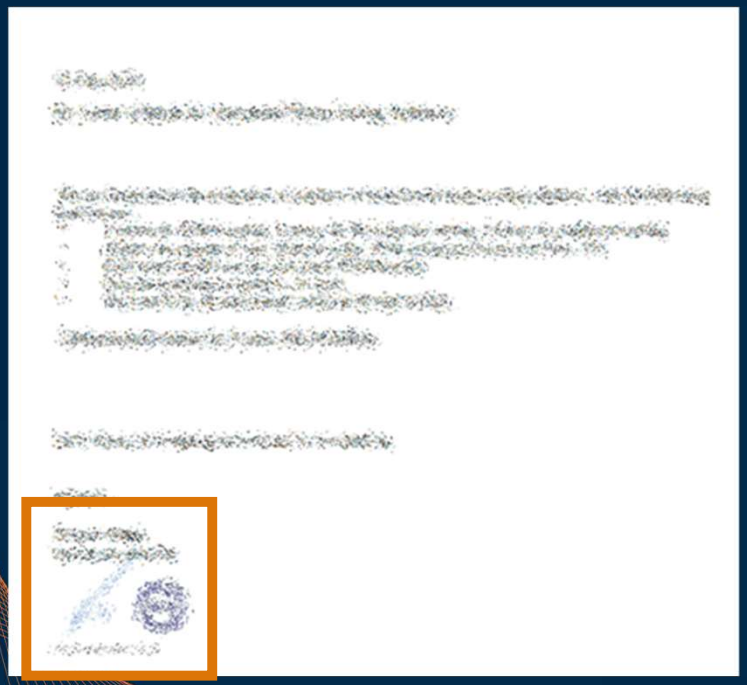
S$23.X Million

from 5 customers globally



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Industry signals can manifest through various levels of commitment



Humans Sign Agreements!

Who signs your first cheque?
What does he/she value?

PERCEIVED VALUE
(Emotional)

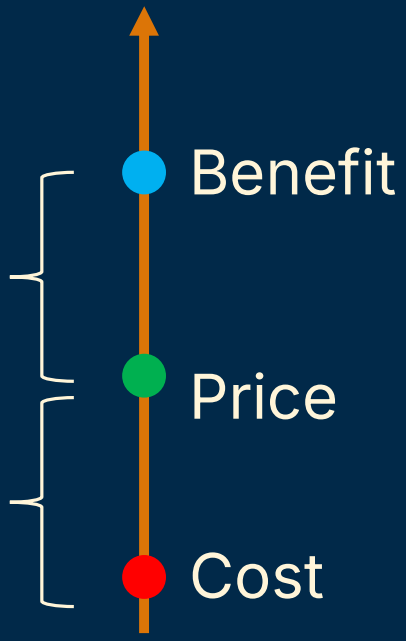
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Perceived Value (customer)

Profit Margin (supplier)

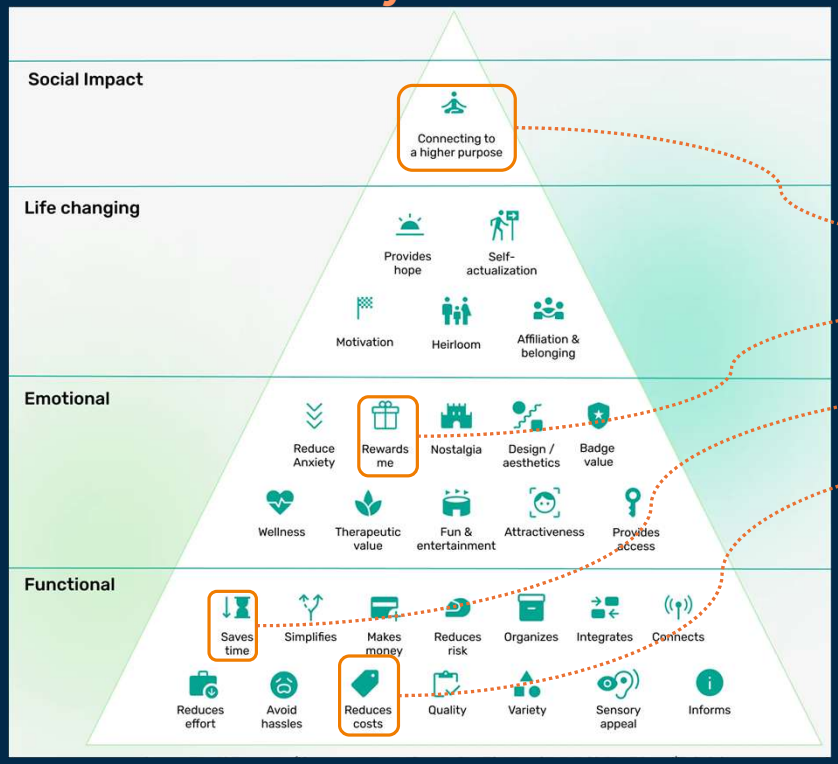


Win-Win!
How to maximize?

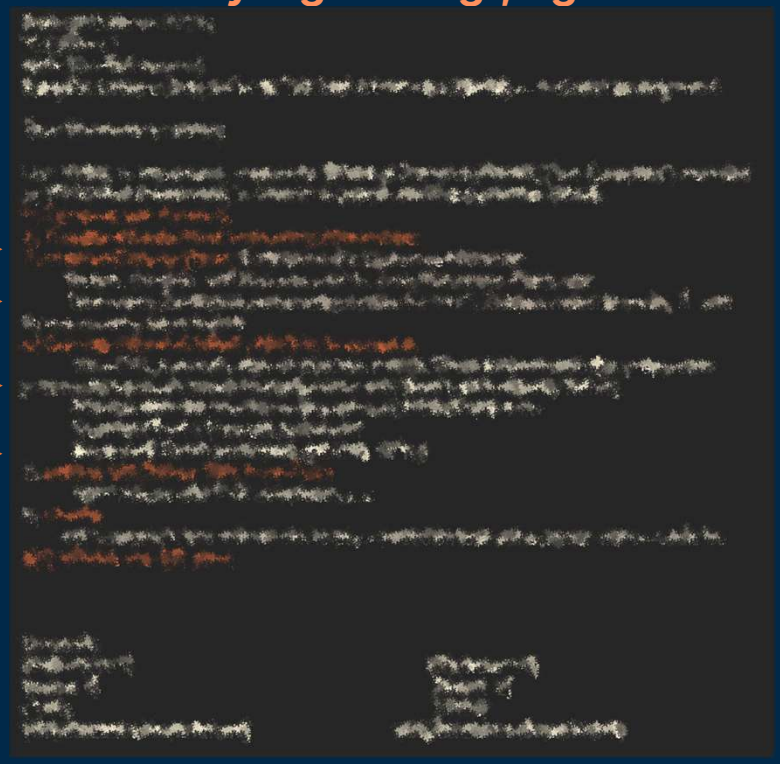
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Objective: Understanding and Capturing Perceived Value

1. Value Hierarchy



2. Industry signal: e.g., agreement



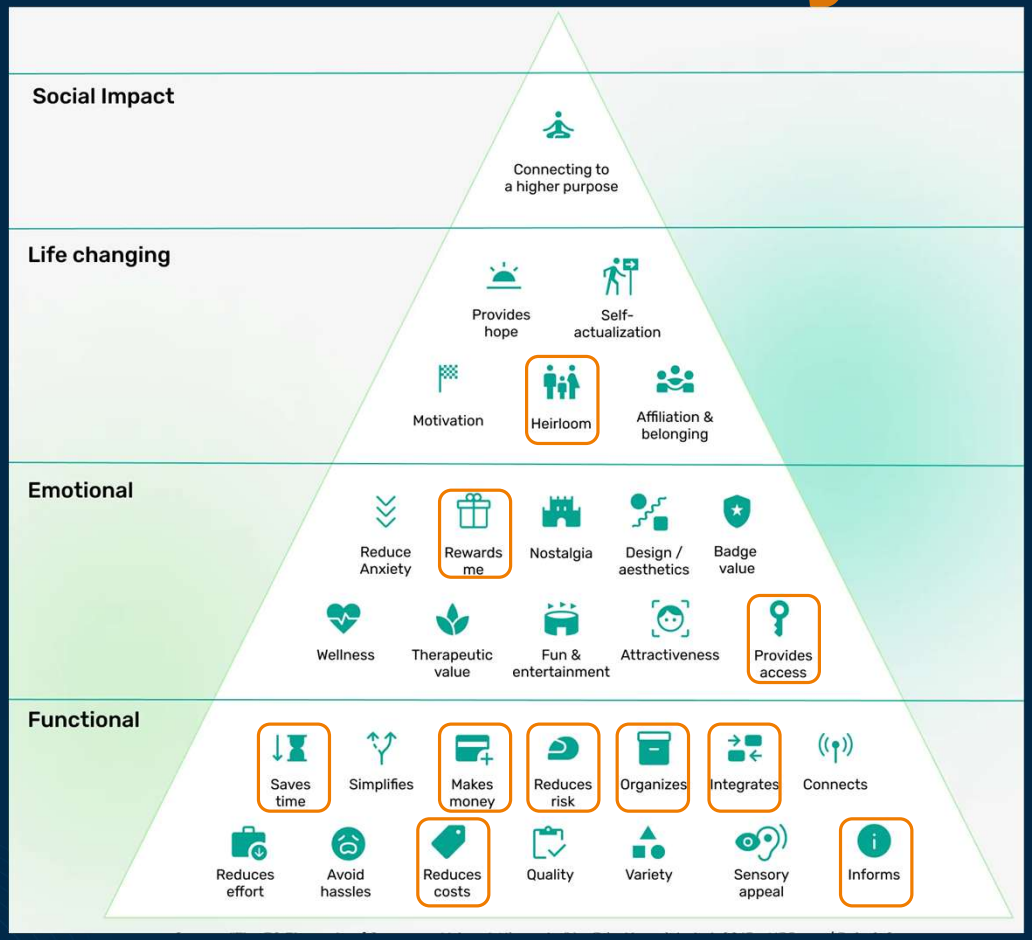
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Source: Almquist, Eric, et al. "The Elements of Value." Harvard Business Review, 2016, hbr.org/2016/09/the-elements-of-value
"The Elements of Value." Bain & Company, media.bain.com/elements-of-value. Accessed 24 Mar. 2026.

Understanding the Perceived Value

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Value Hierarchy



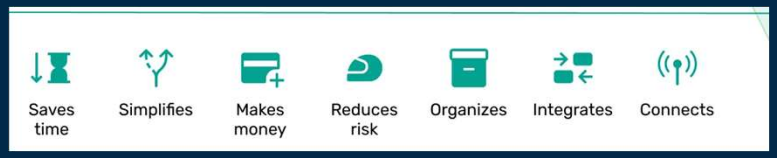
- ✓Products and services address four kinds of needs
- ✓More elements → Loyal customers → Sustained revenue growth

Quantitative: Objective/Measurable

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Source: Almquist, Eric, et al. "The Elements of Value." Harvard Business Review, 2016, hbr.org/2016/09/the-elements-of-value
"The Elements of Value." Bain & Company, media.bain.com/elements-of-value. Accessed 24 Mar. 2026.

Value Hierarchy: Functional



- ✓ **Saves time:** Online order and delivery
- ✓ **Simplifies:** Apple pay reduces complexity
- ✓ **Makes money:** Advertising on websites
- ✓ **Reduce Risks:** 30-day free return, insurance
- ✓ **Organizes**: Storage rental spaces helps you declutter
- ✓ **Integrate:** Different services - payroll, billing, sales
- ✓ **Connects**: NTUC share-a-textbook in community



- ✓ **Reduces effort**: Facebook adds messenger
- ✓ **Avoid hassles:** Free shipping
- ✓ **Reduce cost**: Budget airlines
- ✓ **Quality**: best overall 5G coverage in Singapore
- ✓ **Variety:** Coca-Cola sells soda, tea, water, etc.
- ✓ **Sensory appeal:** Coffee shops ambiance
- ✓ **Informs**: Energy ratings, sugar ratings, nutrition facts

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Value Hierarchy: Emotional



- ✓ Reduce Anxiety: Block lost credit card
- ✓ Reward me: Airlines tier upgrades
- ✓ Nostalgia: Nokia retro phones
- ✓ Design: Apple products
- ✓ Badge value: Rolex represents status



- ✓ Wellness: Subway calorie labelling
- ✓ Therapeutic value: Massage footwear
- ✓ Fun: Cruise ships non-stop entertainment
- ✓ Attractive: Fragrance
- ✓ Provide access: University provides access to NGRIP

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Value Hierarchy: Life Changing



- ✓ **Provides hope:** Addiction recovery, career services
- ✓ **Self-actualization:** Online certificates like Coursera
- ✓ **Motivation:** streaks in fitness apps, stock trading tools
- ✓ **Heirloom:** Engagement rings, watches
- ✓ **Affiliation:** Loyal sports teams

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Value Hierarchy: Social

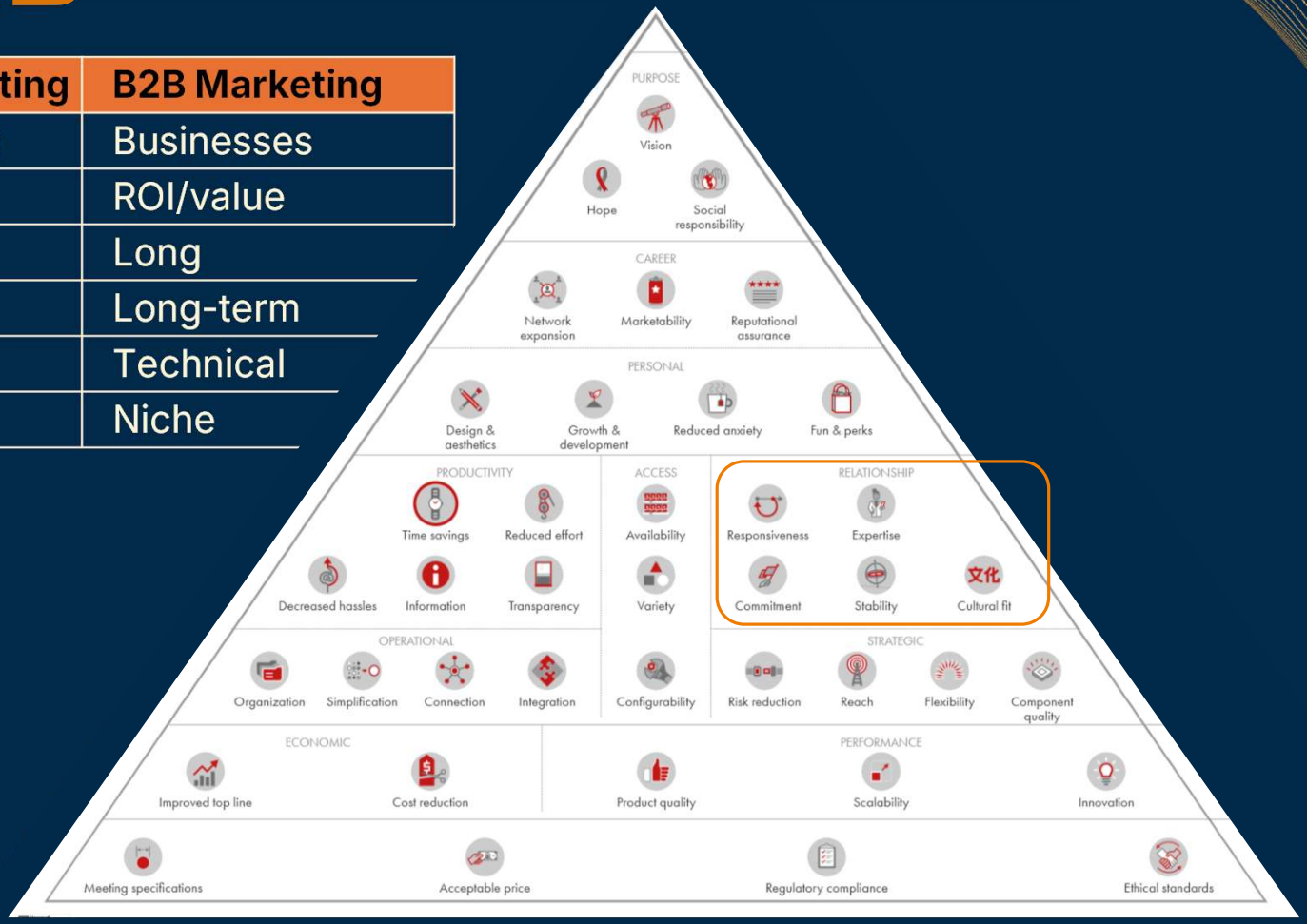


- ✓ **Higher purpose:**
  - Ethical sourcing & Fair trade e.g., Cocoa
  - Donation at checkout e.g., Mc Donalds
  - Buy one, give one
  - Pay fair wages

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B2C vs B2B

Aspect	B2C Marketing	B2B Marketing
Audience	Consumers	Businesses
Focus	Emotion	ROI/value
Sales cycle	Short	Long
Relationships	Loyalty	Long-term
Messaging	Simple	Technical
Targeting	Broad	Niche



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Source: "The B2B Elements of Value." Bain & Company, 5 Feb. 2018, www.bain.com/insights/explore-the-b2b-elements-of-value-interactive/. Accessed 24 Mar. 2026.

How is Value Hierarchy Useful?

Customer Segments



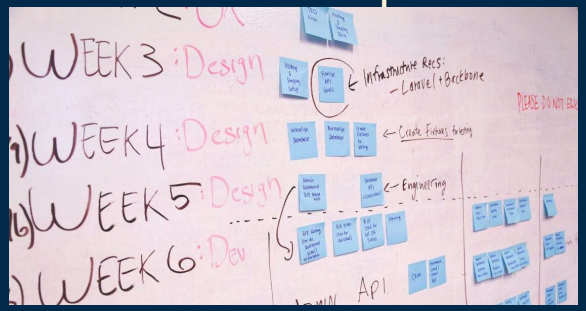
Initial Pricing



Competitive Analysis



Product Development



Sales Messaging



Talent Attraction

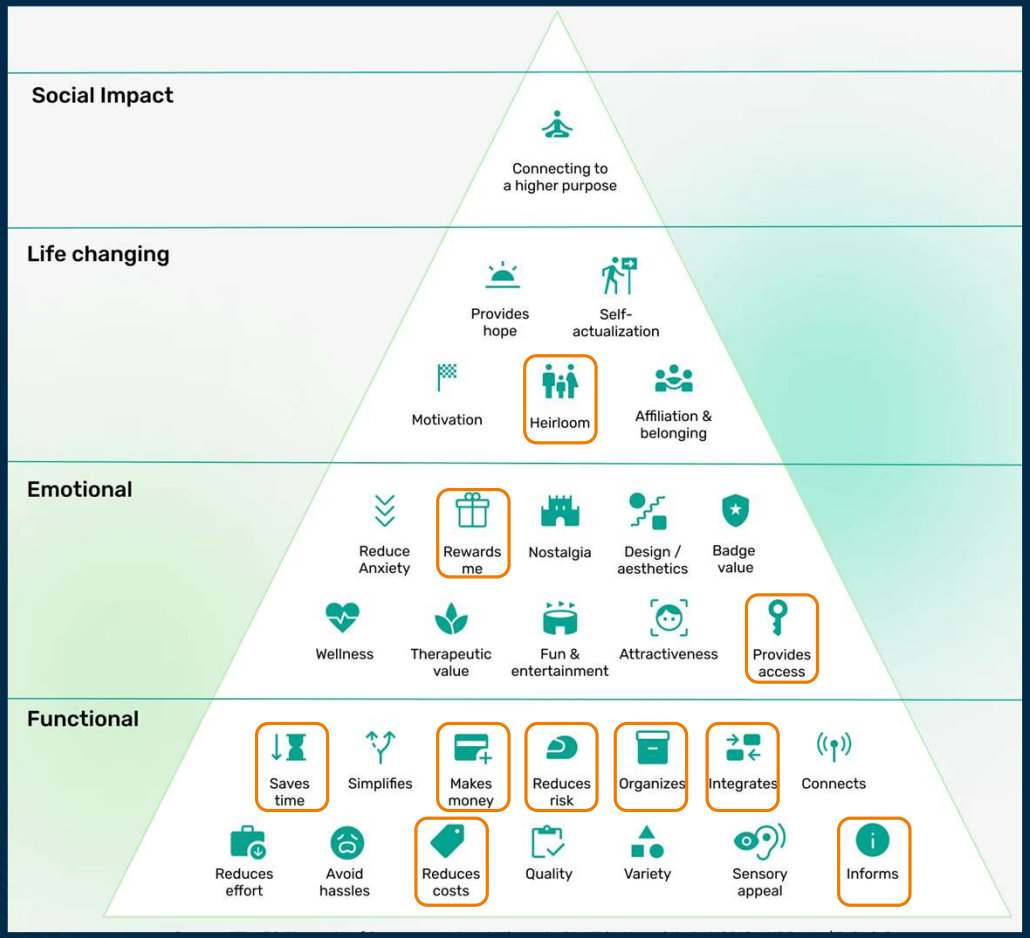


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Exercise #1

1. For each level, state three values for your product/service.
2. For each value, describe your product feature that delivers the value. Quantify where possible.



Level	Value #1	Value #2	Value #3
Social Impact	**Higher purpose:** 5% of profits committed to planting trees, saving planet."		
Life Changing	**Heirloom:** Provides a durable, high-quality product designed to last for generations.		
Emotional	**Rewards Me:** our cash back program gives back 1.5%		
Functional	**Saves Time:** our 1-click pay feature, Automates the payment process saves time by 60%.		

Quantitative: Objective/Measurable

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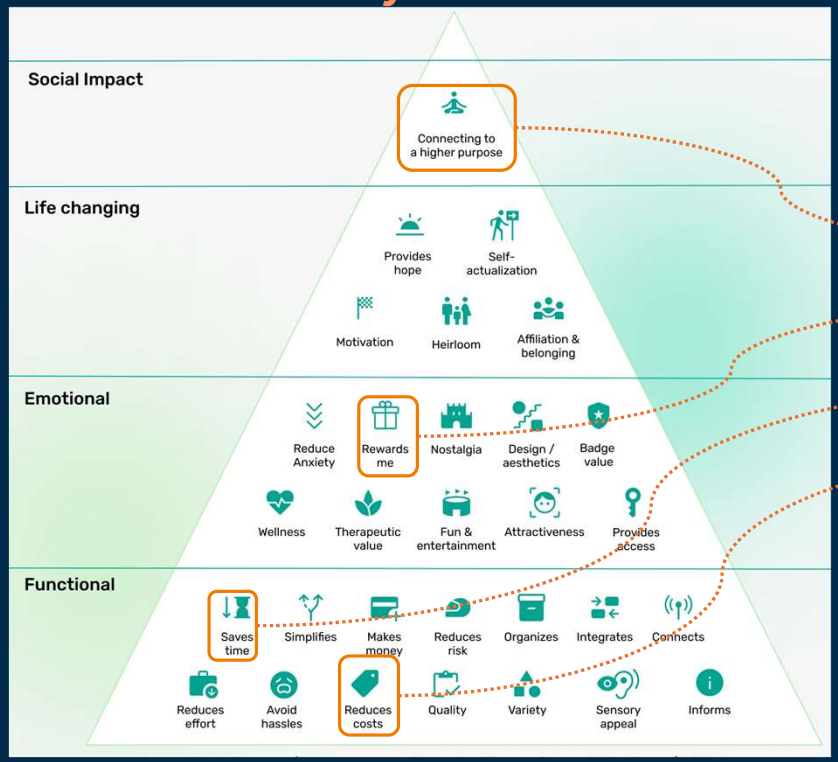
Interactive Link: "The Elements of Value." Bain & Company, media.bain.com/elements-of-value. Accessed 24 Mar. 2026.

Capturing the Perceived Value

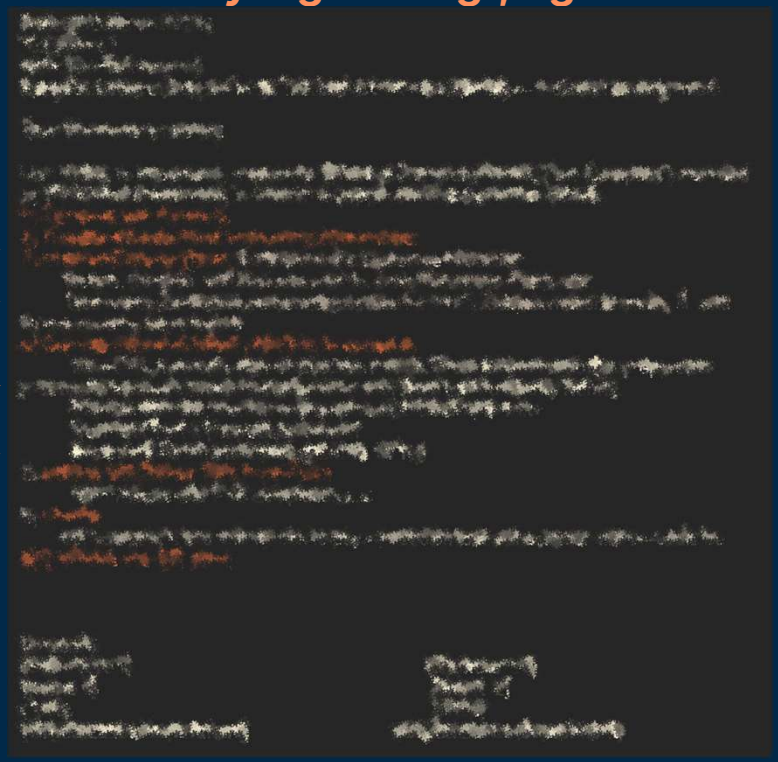
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Goal: Understanding and Capturing Perceived Value

1. Value Hierarchy



2. Industry signal: e.g., agreement



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Industry Signals

AI/Software: Paid pilot with a corporate client

Manufacturing: Co-developing prototype for integration into their line

Sustainability: Corporate agreeing to run a waste-reduction pilot

Biotech: Hospital partnership to access patient samples

Energy/Materials: Lab-scale collaboration agreement with a channel partner

MedTech: Letter of support from a global Key Opinion Leader

FoodTech: F&B chain agreeing to test ingredient

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Exercise #2: Agreement Letter

The Goal: Shift from a technological experiment to a strategic investment, providing tangible INDUSTRY SIGNAL

Date: [DD Month YYYY]
To: [Name]
Attn: [Contact Person]
Subject: Letter of Support for **[STARTUP COMPANY NAME]** — PoC and Scaling Intent

Dear [Sir/Madam / Name],

I am writing to express my support for **[Startup Company Name]** ("the Company"), founded by **[Founder(s) Name(s)]**, in relation to **[application/programme name]**.
1) Company and Problem
2) Proposed Solution and compelling Differentiator
3) Proof-of-Concept (PoC): Commitment & Resource Allocation
Scope, Duration, and Success criteria. Cost, Disruption, Risks, Process disruptions, etc.
Resources: Dedicated personnel (oversee the PoC), Subject matter experts, IT and Space access, Sales teams
4) Commercialization Intent (If PoC is Successful)
If the PoC meets the agreed success criteria, **[Your Organisation]** is prepared to proceed to a paid commercial engagement with **[Startup Company Name]**, subject to internal approvals, budget availability, and contracting/procurement processes.
Payment Model: Monthly subscription of **SGD $[X]/month**
Contract Term: [X]-year agreement (with option to renew for **[X years]**, if applicable)
Expected Commencement: [Month YYYY] (following PoC completion and necessary approvals)

5) Scaling and Rollout Plan (Post-PoC)
Upon successful PoC completion, **[Your Organisation]** intends to scale deployment from **[PoC scope: X users / X site(s) / X department(s)]** to **[target scope: X departments/sites]**, covering approximately **[X users]**, in a phased manner:
Phase 1 (PoC): [X weeks/months], [scope]
Phase 2 (Initial Rollout): expand to **[X sites/departments]** within **[X months]** after PoC completion
Phase 3 (Full Scaling): expand to **[final target scope]** within **[X months]** (or by **[target date]**)
6) Closing
Overall, we believe [Startup Company Name] is well positioned to deliver value in [industry/space]. Subject to a successful PoC, our company's total willingness to pay—based on total subscription value—could be $[X] Millions over [Y] years.

Non-Binding: This letter is non-binding and for reference only. Any engagement is subject to internal approvals and definitive agreements.
Please feel free to contact me at **[email]** or **[phone]** if you need further details.

Sincerely,

[Signature 1]	**[Signature 2]**
[Name 1]	**[Name 2]**
[Title]	**[Title]**
[Organization/Department]	**[Organization/Department]**

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Area of Expertise

- ✓ 20+ patents, h-index 16
- ✓ Customer Discovery & Business Validation
- ✓ New Venture Creation & Intrapreneurship
- ✓ Technology Commercialization (AI & IoT)
- ✓ Strategic Partnerships & Ecosystem Building
- ✓ Diverse Sector Product Innovation



Dr. Sidharta Andalam

Venture Architect | Associate Director | Senior Research Scientist | ex-Robert Bosch